LINUX COMMANDS

Commands for displaying, searching, sorting, and editing files

1. head – Display the beginning of a file

Displays the first 10 lines of a file by default.

```
head file
```

Display a specific number of lines:

```
head -5 file
```

Display a specific number of bytes from the beginning:

```
head -c 20 file
```

2. tail – Display the end of a file

Displays the last 10 lines of a file by default.

```
tail file
```

Display the last 5 lines:

```
tail -5 file
```

Display the last 20 bytes:

```
tail -c 20 file
```

3. cat – Display, combine, and create files

A. Display the contents of a file:

```
cat file
```

B. Combine two files and write the result into a third file:

```
cat file1 file2 > file3
```

The contents of file1 appear first, followed by the contents of file2. The result is saved in file3.

C. Create a file and type its contents from the keyboard:

```
cat > file3
(type your text)
Ctrl + D
```

D. Create/write a file using a Here Document (Heredoc):

```
cat > file4 << stop
Hello
Linux
```

```
Operating System
stop
```

The delimiter (stop) must appear alone on the final line. It can be replaced with another marker such as EOF.

E. Copy the contents of one file into another:

```
cat file1 > file5
```

4. tac – Display lines in reverse order

```
tac file
```

Prints the lines from bottom to top. It reverses line order, not the characters inside each line.

5. more – View a file page by page

```
more file
```

Useful for reading long files one screen at a time.

- Space: next page
- Enter: next line
- q: quit

6. less – View and navigate through a file

```
less file
```

Allows forward and backward navigation.

- Space: next page
- b: previous page
- Up / Down arrows: move line by line
- q: quit

7. strings – Extract readable text from a binary file

```
strings /bin/dash
```

Prints sequences of printable characters found in a binary file, such as an executable. It does not display the entire program as readable source code.

8. sort – Sort lines

```
sort file
sort -r file
```

sort displays lines in ascending lexicographical order by default. The -r option reverses the sorting order.

```
sort file > sorted_file
```

This saves the sorted output into a new file.

9. wc – Count lines, words, and bytes

```
wc file
```

The default output contains: lines, words, bytes, and the file name.

10. stat – Display file metadata

```
stat file
```

Displays detailed information about a file, including its size, permissions, and timestamps.

11. grep – Search for a pattern

```
grep word file
```

Prints every line that matches the given word or pattern.

12. nano – Create and edit text files

```
nano file.txt
```

Opens an existing file for editing or creates a new file if it does not exist.

Shortcut	Function
Ctrl + O	Save (Write Out)
Enter	Confirm the file name
Ctrl + X	Exit
Ctrl + K	Cut the current line
Ctrl + U	Paste
Ctrl + W	Search
Ctrl + G	Help